

How to Get a Scratch Org for Headless Salesforce Demo Dev

Why You Need a Scratch Org

For headless React + Agentforce development, you need a **scratch org** — not an SDO, not a Developer Edition org. Here's why the other options don't work:

Org Type	Problem
SDO (Sales Demo Org)	Production demo org — the "React Development with Agentforce Vibes" toggle won't appear (only available in non-prod orgs)
Developer Edition	Also unsupported for Salesforce Multi-Framework (Beta) — the toggle still won't appear
Scratch org	✅ Works!

Salesforce Multi-Framework (Beta) is only available in **sandbox** and **scratch orgs** where **English** is the default language.

Step 1: Get a Dev Hub

A **Dev Hub** is a parent org that lets you create and manage scratch orgs. You need one before you can create a scratch org.

Request a **Personal Developer Edition org** — free, persistent, fully yours. Sign up at developer.salesforce.com. Recommended for personal dev work. You can't use a Salesforce email, I used my personal one!

Once you have a DE org, enable Dev Hub:

1. Setup → Quick Find → **Dev Hub**
2. Toggle **Enable Dev Hub** → Save

Step 2: Check if You Need Data 360

Ask yourself: **does my app need Data 360?** If so, you'll need to turn on Data 360 and let it fully activate before creating a scratch org.

Use Case	Need Data 360?
React app using standard Salesforce CRM data	✗ No
Agent grounding on Data 360 unified profiles or calculated insights	✓ Yes

If you're just using CRM data with Agentforce, **skip Data Cloud entirely** — it saves a lot of setup time.

Step 3a: Have Cursor/Claude create your scratch org

Simply ask Cursor or Claude to spin up your scratch org! Feel free to provide any requirements in natural language. You'll just need to be logged into your Dev Hub org.

! If you do this, skip step 3b.

Step 3b: Configure Your Scratch Org Definition

In your project, open (or create) `config/project-scratch-def.json`. A minimal config for React + Agentforce on CRM data:

```
{
  "orgName": "Headless Demo Org",
  "edition": "Developer",
  "features": ["Einstein1AIPlatform"]
}
```

Don't add `DataCloud`, `Agentforce`, or other features to this file unless you specifically need them — they'll cause an `Invalid Features` error. Enable Agentforce manually in Setup after the org is created.

Make sure you're logged into your Dev Hub, then run:

```
sf org create scratch -f config/project-scratch-def.json -a my-demo-org
```

Open it with:

```
sf org open -o my-demo-org
```

Step 4: Manual Setup Toggles (Required!)

These can't be done by an IDE or set via `scratch-def.json` — you have to enable them manually in the UI every time you create a new scratch org:

- ☐ Setup → Quick Find → Digital Experience → Enable
 - ☐ In Digital Experiences | All Sites, click **New**. This step ensures that required dependencies are created. You don't need to choose a site template, so click **Back to Setup** in the site creation wizard.
- ☐ Setup → Permission Sets → New → System Permissions → Add "Customize Application" → Manage Assignments → Assign to yourself
- ☐ Setup → Quick Find → React → Enable "React Development with Agentforce Vibes and Salesforce Multi-Framework (Beta)"
- ☐ Setup → **Einstein** → Turn on Einstein
- ☐ Setup → **Agentforce** → Turn on Agentforce
- ☐ Setup → **My Domain** → Routing and Policies → Cookies → uncheck "Require first party use of Salesforce cookies" (*critical – the chat widget breaks without this*)

Troubleshooting

"React Development with Agentforce Vibes" toggle not appearing in Setup You're likely on an SDO or Developer Edition org. Switch to a scratch org.

"No matching items found" when searching Setup for Multi-Framework Same issue — wrong org type. Scratch org required.

Scratch org creation fails with "Invalid Features" Remove `DataCloud`, `Agentforce`, or other unsupported features from your `scratch-def.json`. Only `Einstein1AIPlatform` is reliably available.

Dev Hub doesn't have Data Cloud available If you actually need Data Cloud, enable it on your Dev Hub first via Setup → Data Cloud, then add `"DataCloud"` to your scratch-def features. Note: you'll need to create a new scratch org — you can't add features to an existing one.